ZEXVRO — Funding & Infrastructure Plan

Where we are · what we spent · what the next build needs — and exactly what each dollar funds

3rd place · Stellar Garage Pune | Unified Web3 PaaS | Stellar + AWS

2026-08-15 · live AWS + on-chain data snapshot

Current standing

Five live services, mainnet contracts, real bootcamp usage.

3rd place

Stellar Garage Pune build station — grant funding secured for the next build.

5 services

Zer0 · Morph · REQWID · NFTo · DEDSEC on one unified Web3 PaaS.

Mainnet live

NFTo WASM + checkout, Zer0 privacy pools deployed on Stellar mainnet.

Real users

labs.zexvro.in bootcamp platform running SPPU learners.

One sentence

ZEXVRO is a unified Web3 PaaS helping teams move from Web2 to Web3 infrastructure through private, verifiable, agent-ready services. Developer-first, Vercel/Cloudflare clarity, Stellar rails.

What we have spent so far

Real numbers, pulled live from AWS Cost Explorer + Stellar mainnet.

≈ $0

AWS billed (3 mo)

Covered by AWS startup credits + free tier

≈ $86/mo

AWS list price (worker off)

What the bill really is when credits expire

≈ $211/mo

AWS list price (worker on)

ZK prover EC2 running 24/7 adds ~$125

≈ $8–14

On-chain (Stellar)

≈50–90 XLM total contract deploys + fees

Where the money actually sits

Cash on-chain today: Zer0 deployer 5.42 XLM · NFTo sponsor 8.02 XLM (≈ $2 total at $0.159/XLM). No salary drawn — 3 co-founders. The platform is effectively free to run right now because credits absorb the AWS bill.

Separate project note: peakCTF resources in the same AWS account are NOT ZEXVRO — excluded from this plan.

Free today — not free tomorrow

AWS startup credits expire. Plan on list price so the bill is survivable.

Cost Explorer reports $0 for 3 months — but App Runner, Fargate and the ALB have run continuously since July. The bill appears the day credits run out.

Three free cost wins — do these now

Release EIP 52.23.146.176

Billed $3.60/mo while the ZK instance is stopped. Release it or pair with auto start/stop.

Keep ZK worker OFF by default

The ~$125/mo line. Lambda auto start/stop already exists — wire it.

Cap CloudWatch retention

agent-backend logs already ~90 MB. Set 14-day retention now.

Action: verify credit balance + expiry in the AWS Billing console this week.

Roadmap — Phases A to D

From unify-the-spine to first client. Mapped to docs/roadmap-unified-paas.md.

A · Unify the spine

Weeks 1–3

Service Registry, one gateway, one identity, green tests. ~$0 new infra.

B · Unify value

Weeks 4–6

ZCR metering plane, workspace provisioning, audit+health, onboard NFTo + DEDSEC. +$30–60/mo.

C · Agentic + delivery

Weeks 7–10

Morph + REQWID as modules, CI/CD, cost discipline. +$10–40/mo.

D · Programs + team

Weeks 10+

SCF / accelerators, first part-time hires, land-and-expand first client. Salaries dominate.

North star

One identity, one workspace, one credits ledger, one control plane — five pluggable services. Excludes: multi-chain, A2A Trade, new paid infra before Phase B.

Infrastructure cost per phase

Monthly list-price deltas. Infra is small; team salaries are the real line.

Phase	Monthly delta	What it funds
Current footprint (worker off)	$86/mo	2× App Runner + Fargate gate + ALB + serverless
Phase A — unify spine	**+$0/mo**	Pure code + gateway routing. No new paid infra.
Phase B — ledger + workspace	**+$30–60/mo**	RDS Postgres ($13–60) + Redis ($13–40) for the control plane
Phase C — agentic + CI	**+$10–40/mo**	CI runners, optional premium Soroban RPC ($0–99), LLM for Morph
Phase D — programs + team	**salaries**	Part-time security/devrel/BD hires; infra stays sub-$200/mo

Rule of thumb

Don't add any system until a phase needs it. Every premature service adds fixed cost to a credits-funded runway.

What IPFS, databases and the rest cost

Cheap first step vs scale step — only when a phase actually needs them.

System	Cheap / first step	Scale step
Postgres (ledger/audit)	RDS t4g.micro ~$13/mo	Aurora Serverless v2 $60–120/mo
Redis (DEDSEC anti-replay)	ElastiCache Serverless $25–40/mo	Managed node $13–50/mo
IPFS / de-pin storage	Keep S3 + CloudFront (default)	Pinata $20/mo · self-host ~$30 · Storj $4–8/TB
Soroban RPC	Public RPC — free	QuickNode/Ankr premium $49–99/mo
ZK proving capacity	EC2 batch + spot ≈ $0–36/mo	Reserved/GPU only if real-time proofs
Analytics + observability	PostHog/Grafana free tiers — $0	Self-host ClickHouse $30–100/mo

Decision already made

NFT media stays on AWS S3 + CloudFront (decided in context.md). IPFS remains an optional legacy mode — only adopted if a client explicitly requires content-addressed storage.

Grant scenarios — runway

Plug in the real Stellar Garage Pune amount; these are the brackets.

Conservative

$5,000

Infra + tools for ~1 year

Runway ≈ 33+ months (infra only)

Base

$10,000

Phases A–D + first part-time hires

12-mo cash need ≈ $8k–12k

Optimistic

$25,000

Hires + GTM + working capital

Runway ≈ 50–80 months (infra only)

The real constraint

Infrastructure is NOT the bottleneck — it's ~$86–150/mo. The constraint is time and team: with 3 founders working for free the 12-month need is small; the moment you hire, salary becomes the burn.

Milestone by milestone

Base scenario: exactly what each dollar funds, in order.

Milestone	When	Cash	Used for (exactly)
M0 · Unify the spine	Weeks 1–3	**$0–500**	Service Registry + gateway/auth + green tests; domains + one CloudFront origin
M1 · Unify value	Weeks 4–6	**$500–1,000**	RDS Postgres + Redis (or first credits) + premium RPC for load tests
M2 · Agentic + delivery	Weeks 7–10	**$1,000–2,500**	CI runners, LLM API budget for Morph, RPC, legal/ops
M3 · Programs + team	Weeks 10–16	**$3,000–10,000**	SCF/T-Hub/MeitY applications + 1 part-time security reviewer + devrel (3–6 mo)
M4 · First client	Weeks 16+	**$5,000–15,000**	Working capital for infra + onboarding support; free-trial isolation
12-month total	—	**≈ $8k–12k**	**3 co-founders, no salary**

Use-of-funds split

40% product/infra · 40% go-to-market · 20% ops/G&A — benchmarked from the startup-financial-modeling skill.

How the plan pays for itself

Billing streams already live today — unified credits ledger routes them in Phase B.

ZCR credits

$0.05 / ZCR

Packs + custom amounts. Freemium wedge: one service free, pay for the rest.

NFTo

USDC per NFT (SEP-41)

Fixed-price primary checkout; fees cover the sponsor envelope.

DEDSEC

USDC per request (x402)

Pay-per-request; settle before release. Scale: per-1k-tokens later.

Business model

Usage SaaS, not seats. Infra must be costed per unit of usage (per checkout, per request, per proof). Targets: gross margin 75–85%, CAC payback < 12 months, LTV/CAC > 3.

Goals (OKR shape)

Measurable, evidenced, bounded — written with the define-goal skill.

OKR 1 — Unify the platform

All 5 services read one Service Registry; console, landing, docs and Morph agent render the same catalog; `npm run lint && npm test && npm run build` green (12 failing tests fixed).

Evidence: refactored serviceCatalog.ts consumed by ~20 hardcoded copies; CI badge green on main.

OKR 2 — First paying usage

≥1 workspace pays for a ZCR pack OR 3 NFTo studios deploy mainnet collections, with ≥1 settlement per service recorded in memory.md.

Evidence: credits ledger entries + on-chain sale/checkout hashes.

OKR 3 — Cost discipline

AWS list-price burn ≤ $120/mo; ZK worker off by default with Lambda auto start/stop proven; EIP released; log retention capped; credits checked monthly.

Evidence: Cost Explorer < $120, worker stopped, cost doc refreshed.

Execution checklist + asks

Free cost wins this week, Phase A build in weeks 1–3.

Week 1 (free)	Release EIP · cap log retention · verify AWS credit balance & expiry · confirm peakCTF ownership (separate project — excluded) · lock the real grant amount into the plan.
Weeks 1–3 · Phase A (~$0)	A1 Service Registry (first funded build) · A0 fix 12 red tests · A2 unified gateway origin · A3 one Cognito session across services.
Weeks 4–6 · Phase B (first paid infra)	B1 ZCR metering plane · B2 workspace provisioning · B3 audit+health · B4 onboard NFTo + DEDSEC. Provision RDS/Redis only when the ledger write path is ready.
Ongoing	Monthly AWS cost check into memory.md · run the new skills (planning-with-files, startup-financial-modeling, fundraising) for grants.

Ask: grant amount + go-ahead on Phase A1 Service Registry → then I start building.